done the wrong thing. They are on the wrong side of history', [19] Clinton announced the imposition of economic sanctions on India. From the testimonies of responsible US officials before the United States Congressional Committee for South Asia on 13 May 1998, the Chinese may have figured that the American unhappiness was the consequence of the perceived setback to the process of securing Congressional ratification for the CTBT because of the Indian, and also possibly Pakistani, tests. The tests undermined the freeze-cap-rollback policy of the Clinton administration, and the CTBT that was a key achievement of Clinton's foreign policy. It was already facing pushback in the Senate. China likely worked on the presumption that the US would be very keen to stop Pakistan from following India, which might increase the value of China to the Americans. Their impression was confirmed when Clinton used the Hot Line for the first time ever to talk to China's leader, Jiang Zemin, about nuclear developments in South Asia. [20] China might have felt reassured by the strong American reaction to India's tests, and formulated its response accordingly. One of the hallmarks of Chinese diplomatic practice is that they rarely react impulsively. It helps when there is no free media or a watchful political opposition, but that is not the whole explanation. The decision-making process in China is deliberative, and at the official level (Ministries of Foreign Affairs, National Defence, State Security, etc.), it also pulls in the strategic community's inputs and weighs the global responses before the matter goes up the political chain of command for a decision. As a result, China's response time is longer. The Chinese, after full consideration, identified two major objectives: to punish India, and to rectify the damage that India had done to China's image. It developed its larger diplomatic strategy around these objectives.